Akoizo Original Practice - 2027 Rotation Form 1 - Answer key

Division C | Astronomy | 50-minute written practice

Original Akoizo curriculum practice. This is not a historical tournament paper. Written build, CAD, lab and communication exercises supplement real practical preparation.

ANSWER KEY - Review only after submitting.

1. (2 points) Distance for p = 0.05 arcsec?

Unit: Observational astronomy and the electromagnetic spectrum.
Worked-case data: A star has parallax 50 mas and approximate blackbody temperature 5800 K.

A. 5 pc

B. 200 pc

C. 20 pc

D. 0.05 pc

Correct: C

2. (2 points) On a log scale, 1 -> 10 and 10 -> 100 represent…

Unit: Advanced graph and image interpretation.
Worked-case data: Two stars have equal effective temperature but luminosities 1 and 100 Lsun. Compare radii.

A. The same multiplicative factor

B. The same absolute difference

C. A reversed axis necessarily

D. No measurable change

Correct: A

3. (2 points) A pulsar’s ordinary pulse period chiefly tracks…

Unit: Supernovae, white dwarfs, neutron stars, and black holes.
Worked-case data: Use 3 km per solar mass as a rounded Schwarzschild-radius scale for a 10 Msun nonrotating black hole.

A. Rotation and viewing geometry

B. The age of the galaxy

C. The speed of light changing

D. Whole-star breathing

Correct: A

4. (2 points) At fixed radius, doubling T multiplies L by…

Unit: Stellar properties, fusion, and the H-R diagram.
Worked-case data: A star has radius 2 Rsun and temperature 2 Tsun. Calculate L/Lsun.

A. 16

B. 2

C. 4

D. 8

Correct: A

5. (2 points) A positive small wavelength shift conventionally indicates…

Unit: Astrophysics equations and quantitative synthesis.
Worked-case data: A source has m = 10 and M = 5, with negligible extinction. Find distance and compare its flux with the same source at 10 pc.

A. A smaller radius necessarily

B. A lower mass necessarily

C. Recession

D. Approach

Correct: C

6. (4 points) Why can optical darkness indicate matter?

Unit: Galaxies, stellar populations, and the interstellar medium.
Worked-case data: A region is dark in visible light but bright in infrared and contains embedded young sources. Explain without declaring it empty.

answer: Dust can absorb and scatter background light, creating a dark region despite substantial material. (4 points).

7. (4 points) Why is “all fuel is gone” misleading after core hydrogen exhaustion?

Unit: Cloud collapse and mass-dependent stellar evolution.
Worked-case data: A toy main-sequence model uses L □ M^3·^5 and lifetime □ M/L. Compare a 2 Msun star with the Sun.

answer: Hydrogen may remain in outer layers and shell burning or other fusion stages can continue. (4 points).

8. (4 points) Distinguish angular and physical size.

Unit: Observational astronomy and the electromagnetic spectrum.
Worked-case data: A star has parallax 50 mas and approximate blackbody temperature 5800 K.

answer: Angular size is apparent extent on the sky; physical size requires distance and geometry. (4 points).

9. (4 points) What must precede a population-frequency claim?

Unit: Advanced graph and image interpretation.
Worked-case data: Two stars have equal effective temperature but luminosities 1 and 100 Lsun. Compare radii.

answer: The sample selection, sensitivity/completeness, distance support, and measurement definitions must be understood. (4 points).

10. (4 points) Why must Type Ia luminosities be standardized?

Unit: Supernovae, white dwarfs, neutron stars, and black holes.
Worked-case data: Use 3 km per solar mass as a rounded Schwarzschild-radius scale for a 10 Msun nonrotating black hole.

answer: Observed events vary; calibrated light-curve relationships and corrections support distance inference rather than assuming exact identical luminosity. (4 points).

11. (2 points) A synthetic star has parallax 0.01 arcseconds. Use d(pc)=1/p to find distance.

answer: 100 pc (2 points).

Numerical target 100; absolute tolerance 0.2. Accepted units: , pc.

12. (2 points) A standard-candle exercise gives apparent magnitude 11, absolute magnitude 1 and negligible extinction. Use m-M=5log10(d/10 pc). Find d.

answer: 1000 pc (2 points).

Numerical target 1000; absolute tolerance 2. Accepted units: , pc.

13. (2 points) A star has twice the reference radius and the same temperature. Find its luminosity ratio using L proportional to R^2 T^4.

answer: 4 (2 points).

Numerical target 4; absolute tolerance 0.008. Accepted units: , .

14. (2 points) Use Wien's constant 2.90e-3 m K for a 5,800 K star. Find peak wavelength.

answer: 5e-7 m (2 points).

Numerical target 5e-07; absolute tolerance 1e-09. Accepted units: , m.

15. (2 points) An artificial galaxy recession speed is 70 km/s. Use H0=70 km/s/Mpc and the nearby linear Hubble law to find distance.

answer: 1 Mpc (2 points).

Numerical target 1; absolute tolerance 0.002. Accepted units: , Mpc.

16. (2 points) A normalized binary exercise has separation 2 AU and period 2 years. Use total mass in solar masses=a^3/P^2. Find total mass.

answer: 2 solar masses (2 points).

Numerical target 2; absolute tolerance 0.004. Accepted units: , solar masses.

17. (2 points) NASA identifies M82 X-2 as an ultraluminous pulsar. What does a coherent rotation-linked pulse train imply about the compact object, and why is luminosity alone insufficient?

answer: The pulsing compact object is a rotating neutron star. High X-ray luminosity by itself does not uniquely establish that a source is a black hole. (2 points).

18. (2 points) SN 2014J is a Type Ia supernova in M82. Explain why standardized Type Ia luminosities can constrain distance and why dust must be considered.

answer: Compare extinction-corrected apparent brightness with calibrated intrinsic luminosity; dust changes observed brightness and color and can bias inferred distance. (2 points).

19. (2 points) GW170817 was observed in gravitational waves and electromagnetic radiation. Explain the value of this multi-messenger evidence for a neutron-star merger.

answer: The signals independently constrain binary inspiral and luminous ejecta/afterglow, linking compact-object dynamics to an electromagnetic counterpart rather than relying on one signal alone. (2 points).

20. (2 points) Synthetic starburst-galaxy case 1: ultraviolet emission and infrared dust emission both increase. Explain why using only visible light can miss part of the recent star formation.

answer: Dust can absorb shorter-wavelength stellar radiation and reradiate energy in the infrared. Multi-wavelength measurements help constrain obscured young populations; separate other heating sources. (2 points).